

XGameStation (XGS) comes in two major variants: Micro and Pico. The Micro version is unique because it provides out-of-the-box support for Atari-compatible joysticks and controllers. The Pico version, on the other hand, is a stripped-down model of the Micro XGS, with less RAM and Flash capacity. Both of them, however, are build-it-yourself kits.

With the advent of the PlayStation or Wii, XGS has suffered obvious setbacks, yet it is available in most major Asian markets on a severely limited basis.

Pandora

Now, this is what I call true gaming, the FOSS way! Pandora claims to be the most powerful gaming console ever! With a 600 MHz+ CPU (that runs Linux, by the way), an 800x480 16.7 million-colour touch-screen LCD, and OpenGL-compatible 3D hardware, it surely has features to brag about.

Pandora, the hand-held gaming console, is developed by the OpenPandora Project (the name clearly tells you it is open source). It has high-end PDA capabilities, and the Linux version it employs is based on Angstrom. Wait, the best is yet to come! You don't like the default Angstrom Linux? Fret not! Just install your favourite distro! At present, Pandora supports most major distros, including Ubuntu, Gentoo, Mandriva and OpenSUSE. What's more, Pandora can help you access the Net using your favourite browser (Firefox comes pre-installed, though there is support for Chrome and others; just use apt-get). The battery life is quoted as being 10 hours.

You won't find Pandora in a nearby gadget store—you'll have to pre-order it at their site www.openpandora.org. The cost is approximately \$349, though with taxes, etc, it is likely to reach \$380.

Delta 3D

Delta 3D is an open source gaming simulator. It provides all that one can ask for when it comes to game development engines -- a particle editor, world editor, mode creator, compiler and model viewer. It has been released under the GNU LGPL, and is freely re-distributable. The fully customisable source code can be had from www.delta3d.org.

Games for freedom lovers

The options are not too vast when it comes to open source games, but there are some very good ones that can give the proprietary people a run for their money. Let's look at some of the top open source games.

Urban Terror

This is a first-person shooter (FPS), based on Quake III. In Urban Terror, you are exposed to regular hack-and-slash gaming, along with a few jumps and power slides. The gameplay is fun, and once you are accustomed to the controls, it can keep you hooked for hours on end.

The one thing that I personally loved about Urban Terror is that the game aims to be realistic. You will not



Figure 1: Urban Terror gameplay



Figure 2: A scene from Savage 2: The Battle for Netherth



Figure 3: UFO Alien Invasion: detailed gameplay

find characters with magic potions or childish supernatural fantasies. On being shot, your character bleeds, and if medical aid (in multi-player mode) is not administered in time, it may prove fatal. Cool, eh?

Urban Terror is available for Linux, Windows and (don't